Year 6 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y06/Y06_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y06_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For staff only. Use with the Year 6 student paper (`Y06/Y06_Student_Paper_v3.1`), the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`) and the Interviewer guide for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6`). The whole process, the English proficiency bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

Who this is for. Students joining UK Year 6 (age 10 to 11 in September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 4** (四年级); a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 5. The maths tests UK Year 5 content, with a few easier and a few harder items. The science tests UK Year 5 science and working scientifically.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student needs	Student paper pages
1	Welcome	2	Assessor (2.2)		1 (cover)
2	Listening (recording)	about 7	Assessor plays the recording or reads the script (3.1)	pencil	2 to 3
3	Reading paper, Parts A, B and C	12	Student alone; assessor keeps time (3.2)	pencil	4 to 9
4	Writing	10	Student alone (3.3)	pencil	10 to 11
	Break	3 to 5		water	
5	Maths	18	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (4)	pencil, rubber, ruler; no calculator, no protractor	12 to 17
6	Science	8	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (5)	pencil	18 to 21
7	Interview, opening with the sentence reading screen (start at **Level 5**)	12	Interviewer, 1:1 (3.4, 3.5)	sentence reading card; a plain card to cover sentences	
	Total student time	**about 67**, plus the break			

For each candidate:

- the student paper (21 pages, A4, printed at actual size: switch off "fit to page", because the diagrams and the type sizes depend on it);
- the grading sheet (`Y06/Y06_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`), laminated;
- a clock or timer, spare pencils;
- the listening recording (`audio/v3.1/Y06/`) and something to play it on.

The written papers can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; listening is played or read to the group; the interview is always 1:1.

Marks at a glance: listening / 8, reading / 24, writing / 16, maths / 25 (number problems / 9, word problems and pictures / 16, of which word problems / 5), science / 10.

2. Before you start

2.1 Set up

- A quiet, bright room. The student sits where they cannot see other students' papers.
- Write the student's name on the paper if they cannot (in English, with the Chinese name in brackets if the family uses one).
- Have these instructions open at 3.1 for the listening script (if you are not playing the recording), and a timer ready.

Pace of speech. Year 6 students are still learning English: speak a little slower than normal speech, about 155 words a minute. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

2.2 Welcome (say this)

> "Hello, I am [your name]. Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and plan how to help you. Some parts are easy and some parts are hard. That is fine. Do your best. If you do not understand what to do, you can ask me to say it again."

Show the cover page. Point to the "How to answer" examples and say: "Look. You tick a box, write in a box, circle, join with a line, and show your working like this."

2.3 Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English parts (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or reading questions aloud. The student may ask for instructions to be repeated in English.	Read any question aloud in English, at the pace in 2.1, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0, and the grading sheet lists the NT topics.

Extra time or a reader for a known need is allowed: record it on the grading sheet. The number of **L** questions is evidence about English and goes on the grading sheet.

2.4 Stopping rules

- In every part, a student may stop when they have done what they can. Encourage once ("Have a look at the next one; some are easier"), then accept their decision.
- **Listening:** always play the whole recording, or read the whole script twice, even if the student writes nothing.
- **Reading:** let the student work for the full 12 minutes. Stop early only if the student has answered nothing in Part A after 4 minutes, or is upset; record "stopped after 4 minutes" on the Reading front sheet.
- **Writing:** if the student cannot start, say once: "You can write words, or draw and label your plan." Never write for them.
- **Maths and science:** stop at the time. A student who is stuck may be told: "You can go on to the next question."
- A distressed child is never pressed: stop, take a break or end the session, and record it on the grading sheet.

2.5 Keeping the student at ease

- Sit beside rather than opposite if you can. Smile, use the student's name, and praise effort ("Thank you, you are working hard"), not answers.
- Do not show marks or say whether an answer is right.
- Say how many parts are left. Offer water and the break after the writing.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 7 minutes with the recording, / 8)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y06/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. It says the instructions below, reads the eight questions aloud once, plays the script twice (20 seconds apart) and gives one minute to finish, so you do not say or read anything yourself. The two speakers have different voices, so it does not say their names. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of the script takes about 2 minutes, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Say: "Turn to page 2. I am going to read a phone conversation between two friends, Aisha and Jun. They are talking about a film night in the park at Mid-Autumn. First I will read the questions to you. Then I will read the conversation two times. You can answer while I read. Answer on pages 2 and 3."

Read the questions aloud once, slowly, pointing to each number. Do not name or explain the pictures.

> "Question 1. Where will Aisha and Jun meet? Tick one box. Question 2. What time will they meet? Tick one box. Question 3. What must Jun bring? Tick two boxes. Question 4. Who is going to the film night with Aisha? Tick one box. Question 5. How wide is the screen? Question 6. What can they buy in the park? Question 7. Why does Aisha change the place where they meet? Question 8. Jun's piano lesson finishes at six o'clock. Will he be late? Tick yes or no, and explain your answer."

Say: "Now listen. I will read the conversation two times."

Read it twice at about 155 words a minute, a little slower than normal speech. Read both parts yourself: say each speaker's name before their words, and change your voice a little. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, wait 20 seconds, then say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish.

Aisha: Hello, Jun. It's Aisha. Are you still coming to the film night in the park on Saturday?

Jun: Yes! My mum says I can go. Where shall we meet?

Aisha: I said the main gate of Riverside Park, but it gets very crowded there. Let's meet outside the library instead. It's just across the road from the park. [pause]

Jun: OK, outside the library. What time?

Aisha: The film starts at seven o'clock, but we want to find a good place to sit. Can you be there at a quarter past six?

Jun: A quarter past six. My piano lesson finishes at six, and it's only ten minutes from the library. So that's fine. [pause]

Aisha: Great. My dad is coming with us, and my little brother, Leo.

Jun: Do I need to bring anything?

Aisha: Bring a jacket, because it gets cold by the river at night. And bring a little money, about twenty yuan. Dad says we can buy mooncakes there. [pause]

Jun: Is the screen really big? My cousin says it's fifteen metres wide!

Aisha: Yes, it's the biggest outdoor screen in the city. The film is about a panda who travels to the Moon, so it's perfect for Mid-Autumn. [pause]

Jun: What if it rains?

Aisha: Then the film night will be on Sunday instead. Dad will send your mum a message.

Jun: Perfect. See you on Saturday!

Answers. 1 mark each. Spelling and grammar are not marked in listening; the answer must be in English and the meaning must be clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept	What it tests
1	**B** library		A park gate (the first plan, changed)	a change of plan
2	**B** 6:15		A 6:00 (the piano lesson ends), C 7:00 (the film starts)	"a quarter past"; distractor times
3	**A** jacket and **C** money	both ticked and nothing else	umbrella (rain is mentioned), torch (it will be dark, but she does not ask for one)	two details
4	her dad and her little brother		her cousin (only mentioned)	detail
5	**15**	fifteen	50 (fifteen and fifty sound alike)	number
6	mooncakes	moon cakes, mooncake, any recognisable spelling	a film; tickets	key word
7	The main gate gets very crowded.	crowded; too many people there; "many people"	"the library is near the park" (true, but not the reason)	reason stated in the text
8	**No**, because the lesson is only ten minutes from the library, so he gets there at about ten past six, before a quarter past six	No with any reason about the ten minutes or arriving before 6:15	Yes; No with no reason	inference: combines three facts

Band guide

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8
Listening band	**A**	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 need key words and pictures. A student who gets these but none of 5 to 8 usually knows familiar words but cannot yet follow connected speech (band B).
- Questions 1 and 2 have distractors: the first meeting place and the other times in the conversation. Choosing them shows the student caught words but missed the change ("instead", "but").
- Question 8 needs three facts combined (six o'clock, ten minutes, a quarter past six): it separates D from E.
- Compare with "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, / 24)

Say: "Turn to page 4. This is the reading. There are three parts: A, B and C. Read the texts and answer the questions. Part C is hard. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. I cannot help you with the words, but I can say the instructions again. You have 12 minutes."

Start the timer. Say "Two minutes left" at 10 minutes and "Please stop" at 12 minutes. Do not read any text or question aloud and do not explain words.

Marking. Spelling is not marked unless the word cannot be recognised. For "find and copy" the word must be the right word from the text; a small copying slip is fine. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: the café menu (questions 1 to 7, / 8)

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Notes
1	1	¥20	20, 20 yuan	
2	1	10	ten	
3	1	**A** noodle soup		uses the chilli picture and the key
4	1	milk tea		
5	1	20:00	8 pm, eight o'clock, 8 in the evening, 20.00	7:30 is the opening time
6	2	open on Mondays: **False**; fried rice costs more than an egg sandwich: **True**	1 mark each	the second needs a comparison (¥15 and ¥12)
7	1	a drink	a free drink; any drink on the menu	"rice", "food"

Part B: The Rainy Day Picnic (questions 8 to 15, / 8). A story about two years below age level.

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
8	1	Sunday	on Sunday; Sunday morning	Saturday
9	1	fruit and a blanket	both ticked and nothing else	sandwiches (Mum made them)
10	1	red		
11	1	a (big) plant	plant; a flower pot	"a tree" (that is what she called it)
12	1	It started to rain.	it was raining; there was rain; dark clouds and rain	"it was cold"; "Tom was crying"
13	1	Tom's toy animals	toy animals; toys; animals	"a lion" on its own; "sandwiches"
14	1	sad		angry, hungry
15	1	They were enjoying the indoor picnic so much: it was fun, and they did not need the park any more.	any reason about enjoying the indoor picnic or having fun at home; "they were happy at home"	"because it was raining" (it had stopped); a retelling with no reason

Part C: How Seeds Travel (questions 16 to 23, / 8). Age-appropriate non-fiction for a fluent reader of 10.

Q	Marks	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
16	1	retrieval	a tiny parachute of soft hairs	parachute; soft hairs	the wind on its own
17	1	retrieval	Its thick, hairy outer layer traps air.	it has air inside; it is full of air	"it is big"; "it is light"
18	1	vocabulary	survive		grow
19	1	vocabulary in context	move slowly with the water		
20	1	vocabulary in context	being carried by an animal		
21	1	retrieval and inference	any one: too much shade or not enough light; they must share water; they must share space	too dark; no sun; too crowded; not enough water	"the parent eats them"
22	1	inference: applies the text	The seed passes through the bird's body and is dropped in the garden (in its droppings) after the bird flies there.	the bird carries the seed inside it to the garden; the bird drops the seed there	"the wind blows it" (no link to the bird)
23	1	author's purpose	To give a real example: the hooks on burdock seeds gave a person the idea for Velcro.	to show that nature can give people ideas; to make the text more interesting with a true story; to link seeds to something children know	retelling ("because he had a dog")

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example, Part C higher than Part B), and check against the sentence reading screen. Record the reading paper marks and the reading band on the **Reading front sheet** and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Picture support.** A student who scores mainly on questions 1 to 3 may be using the menu pictures and prices, not the words.
- **Copying.** A pattern of copying words that sit next to the question words suggests word matching without understanding (for example "the wind can carry them" for question 16).
- **Inference and purpose.** Questions 21 to 23 separate D from E. A student at band C often gets the retrieval questions and leaves the "why" and "explain" questions blank.
- **Speed.** A student who is accurate but does not reach Part C may decode slowly: check the fluency rating from the sentence reading screen (Reading front sheet) before giving a low band.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, / 16)

Say: "Turn to page 10. This is the writing. Choose A or B, and tick the one you choose. You can plan in the box on page 11, then write on the lines. Write as much as you can. You have 10 minutes."

The task. A: a story that starts when a small robot with an envelope knocks at the door (picture and question prompts). B: a letter to a student in the new class about themselves (prompts for content). Do not give a higher mark

for either choice. In B, the content tells you about the student too: pass anything useful to the interviewer.

Criteria. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 sit between the descriptions). Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or only words copied from the page	A few connected ideas on the topic in a simple order; may be short (3 to 6 sentences) or a list; a letter may have no opening or ending	A complete piece that fits the task: a story with an opening, a problem and an ending, or a letter with a greeting, several developed points and a closing; ideas link across sentences; paragraphs
Vocabulary	No English words, or single words not on the topic	Everyday words that carry the meaning; a few topic words; much repetition (nice, good, like)	Varied, precise words for a 10 year old: chosen verbs, adjectives and adverbs; some ambitious words used correctly
Grammar and sentences	No sentences	Simple sentences with mostly correct word order, joined with and, then, because; frequent errors in tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear	A range of sentences (with when, if, because, although, so that); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling cannot be read; no punctuation	Common words mostly correct, others spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops sometimes	Most words correct, including less common ones; sentence punctuation secure; commas, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct

The writing band is given by best fit with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, not by the total alone. As a rough guide only: totals of 0 to 3 usually fit **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E at this age. A fluent writer of 10 to 11 usually writes about 120 to 200 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with a clear opening and ending suited to the form (a story ending, or a letter's closing such as "I hope to meet you soon"). Sentences vary in length and type, vocabulary is chosen for effect, and dialogue in a story is mostly punctuated correctly. Common words are spelt correctly and harder words plausibly. The errors are the ones any 10 year old makes, not the features of a learner of English (missing "a" and "the", missing past tense -ed or plural -s, Chinese word order).

What to look for

- **Learner features** (missing -s, -ed, articles; "I very like"; "There have many ...") point to C or D even when the content is good.
- **Memorised chunks** in letter B ("My name is ... I am 10 years old. My hobby is ...") with little else usually fit B. Look for what the student adds beyond the textbook pattern.
- **A full plan and little writing** may mean slow writing in English rather than no ideas: say so in the notes on the grading sheet.

3.4 Speaking: the interview (about 8 minutes of questions)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6` and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`). The interviewer records the speaking band and "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet, and speaks at the pace in 2.1. If the listening task (3.1) and listening in conversation differ by more than one band, note why on the Interview sheet.

3.5 Reading aloud: the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (opens the interview, 3 to 4 minutes)

Use `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`. The rules, the interviewer's copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the record is the **Reading front sheet**. **Start at Level 5 (sentence 13)** for Year 6. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Follow the guide's rules for going back, stopping and the meaning checks. Use the "Years 6 to 10" column of the guide's reading age table to turn the reading age into an indicative band, and use it to confirm the reading paper band.

4. Maths (18 minutes, / 25)

Say: "Turn to page 12. This is maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and pictures. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 18 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 5 content, with easier floor items (Year 4) and ceiling items (Year 6). Section A, number problems: 9 marks. Section B, word problems and pictures: 16 marks, of which **word problems: 5 marks** (questions 11, 12, 15 and 18). Every Section B question has a picture, chart, table or diagram.

Marking. Give the mark for a correct answer with or without working. Units are printed in the answer boxes, so they are not needed. Accept answers in a different but correct form unless the question asks for a particular form.

4.1 Section A: number problems (/ 9)

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught (Chinese Grade 4 completed)
1	Add 4-digit numbers (Y4, floor)	1	7 003	7003	6 993, 7 993: carrying slips	
2	12 times table (Y4, floor)	1	108		98, 118	The 11 and 12 times tables are often not learnt (tables go to 9 × 9). Working it out (10 × 9 + 2 × 9) is good reasoning.
3	Round to the nearest 10 000 (Y5)	1	490 000	490000	480 000 (cuts off), 486 000, 500 000	Usually taught in Grade 4 with 四舍五入 to the nearest 万 (48万6350 ≈ 49万), so this should be familiar; the digit grouping in threes may look new.
4	Compare decimals to 3 places (Y5)	1	0.5 circled		0.405 or 0.054: thinks more digits means bigger	Comparing decimals is usually Grade 4.
5	Short division with a remainder (Y5)	1	142 remainder 5	142 r 5; 142..... 5 (Chinese notation); 142 5/6	143 (rounds up), 141 remainder 11 (remainder bigger than 6)	Division with remainders (有余数的除法) is taught from Grade 2; the word "remainder" may be new.
6	4-digit × 2-digit (Y5)	1	78 338	78338	17 030: multiplies by 2 instead of 20 in the second row	Three-digit × two-digit is Grade 4; the method is the same.
7	Mixed number to improper fraction (Y5)	1	11		9 (2 + 3 + 4), 6, 14	Mixed numbers and improper fractions (带分数, 假分数) are usually Grade 5.
8	Add fractions with related denominators (Y5)	1	5/6	10/12 or any equivalent	3/9: adds tops and bottoms	Adding fractions with different denominators (异分母分数加法) is usually Grade 5.
9	Long division (Y6, ceiling)	1	32		31 remainder 23	Division by a two-digit number is Grade 4, so many students will get this.

4.2 Section B: word problems and pictures (/ 16)

W = word problem.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
10	Read a timetable; time intervals (Y5)	2	(a) 10:02 (b) 59 minutes	1 mark each	(b) 99 (subtracts the times like decimals: 12.09 – 11.10), 61, 1 hour 1 minute	Time intervals (经过的时间) are Grade 3; a UK-style timetable may be new.
11 W	Division: use the remainder (Y5)	1	4 buses	4	3 remainder 30, 3.75, 3: does not round up for the context	
12 W	Money with decimals, two steps (Y5)	2	¥9.50	9.5; 9元5角. 2 marks: 9.50. 1 mark: 40.50 (3 × 13.50) seen with no correct second step, or a correct method with one slip	36.50 (50 – 13.50: forgets the 3 notebooks); 40.50 as the final answer	Decimal money calculation is Grade 4.
13	Volume by counting cubes (Y5)	1	24 cm^3	24	12 (counts the top only), 26 (counts the squares you can see: 12 + 8 + 6)	Volume (体积) is usually Grade 5; counting hidden cubes may be new.
14	Perimeter and area of a composite shape (Y5)	2	(a) 36 cm (b) 50 cm^2	1 mark each	(a) 25: adds only the four labelled sides; (b) 80 (10 × 8, ignores the missing corner)	Rectangle area and perimeter are Grade 3; composite shapes (组合图形) are usually Grade 5. Finding the missing sides (6 cm and 5 cm) is the skill.
15 W	Measures: litres and ml, two steps (Y5)	1	500 ml	500	0.5 (right amount but in litres: 0, note it), 1 250 (subtracts one cup), 1 000	Litres and millilitres (升和毫升) are Grade 4 in some textbooks and Grade 5 in PEP.
16	Prime numbers (Y5)	1	11 and 23 circled, and nothing else		9, 15, 21, 27 circled: thinks odd numbers are prime	Prime numbers (质数) are usually Grade 5.
17	Angles on a straight line and around a point (Y5)	2	(a) 56° (b) 120°	1 mark each	(a) 124 (copies), 236; (b) 30, 210 (forgets the right angle)	平角 (180°) and 周角 (360°) are usually Grade 4, so this should be familiar.
18 W	Percentages as hundredths (Y5)	1	35%	35	65 (adds the two numbers given)	Percentages (百分数) are usually Grade 6; a student may still reason that 35 out of 100 is 35%.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
19	Reflection in a mirror line (Y5)	1	The reflected shape is on the right of the line, the same distances away: its long upright side is 4 squares right of the line, its top runs from 2 to 4 squares right, its bottom from 1 to 4 squares right, and its sloping side is nearest the line.	Small drawing inaccuracy if every corner is in the right square	The same shape slid across (sloping side on the far side): a translation, not a reflection	Reflection on a grid (轴对称) is usually Grade 4, so this should be familiar.
20	Line graph with negative numbers (Y5; (b) is a Y6 ceiling item)	2	(a) –5 °C (b) 13 degrees	1 mark each; (a) "minus 5", "5 below zero"	(a) 5 or –6; (b) 3 or –3: works out 5 – 8 instead of 5 – (–8)	Line graphs (折线统计图) are usually Grade 5 and negative numbers Grade 6.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 25	0 to 9	10 to 14	15 to 21	22 to 25
Maths band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

List the NT questions on the grading sheet and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Topics that may not have been taught to a student who has completed Chinese Grade 4: the 12 times table (2), mixed numbers and improper fractions (7), adding fractions with different denominators (8), volume (13), composite shapes (14), litres and millilitres (15), prime numbers (16), percentages (18), line graphs and negative numbers (20). Rounding large numbers, decimals, long multiplication and division, time, money, angles on a line and around a point, and reflection (1, 3 to 6, 9 to 12, 17, 19) are usually taught by the end of Grade 4. Textbooks differ (PEP, 苏教版, 北师大版), so always ask the student.

4.3 What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on number problems (Section A) but poorly on the word problems (11, 12, 15, 18) may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the answer then comes quickly, record it as an English barrier on the grading sheet.
- **Method.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately. A correct answer without working is fine. When an answer is wrong, look at the working: one slip in a sound method is a different need from a wrong method.
- **Conventions.** "Remainder" in words, timetables, "Not drawn accurately", cm^3 and the percentage sign may be new. A student who shows the maths correctly with a picture or working knows the maths, even if the English words are new.

5. Science (8 minutes, / 10)

Say: "Turn to page 18. This is science. Every question has a picture or a table. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 8 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 5 science and working scientifically. Question 7 is the table and fair test question.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
1	Life cycle of an amphibian (Y5)	1	**A** (the young frog with legs and a tail)		B fish: thinks a tadpole becomes a fish	Life cycles (for example the silkworm, 动物的一生) are often taught by Grade 3, so the idea should be familiar.
2	Reversible and irreversible changes (Y5)	2	Reversible: A, C. Irreversible: B, D.	2 marks: all four correct; 1 mark: three correct	A under irreversible: thinks melted chocolate cannot set again	Reversible and irreversible changes are often later (Grade 6 in some textbooks); the meaning of the two words is given on the page.
3	Separating mixtures (Y5)	2	sand and water: filtering; salt dissolved in water: evaporating; small stones and sand: sieving	2 marks: all three; 1 mark: one or two correct	salt water joined to filtering: thinks filtering removes dissolved salt	Dissolving (溶解) is usually Grade 4; separating by filtering and evaporating may be new.
4	Day and night (Y5)	1	The Earth spins around once every day.		"The Sun moves around the Earth": an everyday idea, not an English problem	The Earth's movement is often Grade 5 or 6.
5	Gears (Y5)	1	anticlockwise	an anticlockwise arrow drawn on gear B	clockwise	Simple machines (levers, pulleys and gears) are often Grade 6. The arrows on the page show the meaning of the two words.
6	Forces: gravity and air resistance (Y5)	1	1 air resistance, 2 gravity	both for the mark, in English; spelling not marked; an answer in Chinese scores 0	the two swapped; magnetism	Forces are taught in different grades; the English names may be new.
7	Reading a table; conclusion; fair test (Y5, working scientifically)	2	(a) The bigger the parachute, the longer it takes to fall. (b) any one: the same height; the same weight or load; the same paper or material; the same strings; drop it the same way or in the same place	1 mark each; (b) "same toy", "same high"	(b) "same size" (that is what she changes), "same time" (that is what she measures)	Fair testing in this form is less familiar; judge the student's thinking.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 10	0 to 3	4 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 10
Science band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

What to look for

- **Working scientifically.** Question 7 shows scientific thinking separately from topic knowledge. A student who gets 7 right but marks other questions NT is likely to do well once taught.
- **An English barrier** looks like wrong answers that depend on English words (reversible, evaporating, air resistance) while the picture questions (1, 5) are right. Reading the question aloud, or once in Chinese (L), usually settles it.
- **Everyday ideas** (the Sun moves around the Earth; heavier things always fall faster) are science misconceptions, not English problems.

6. Recording the results

1. Mark the student paper (every question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet (`Y06_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). In maths, also record on the grading sheet whether the number problems against the word problems (Section A / 9, word problems / 5) show an English barrier in maths: yes, no or unsure (see 4.3).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet.
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student paper with them (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 5 and 6

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`).

About 12 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 4 minutes; start Level 4 for Year 5, Level 5 for Year 6; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Smile, sit beside rather than opposite the child if you can, and start with something easy. Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak slowly and clearly: about 140 words a minute in Year 5 and about 155 in Year 6. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (8 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me about yourself and your family.	What is your name? Do you have a brother or sister?	What do you like doing together as a family?
	What did you do last weekend?	Did you go out or stay at home?	What was the best part, and why?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is one thing you would change about it?
	What do you find hard at school? What do you do then?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you learnt something hard.
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read English books?	What helps you remember new words?
	How do you feel about having all your lessons in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What do you think will be hardest?
Interests	What do you like to do after school and at weekends?	Do you like sport, music, art or games?	What are you best at, and how did you get good at it?
	Tell me about a book, film or game you like.	Do you like reading?	Why do you like it? Who would you recommend it to?
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about it?
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend?	What makes someone a good friend?
	What do you do when you feel sad or worried?	Who do you talk to?	
	How do you feel about starting a new school?	Are you happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you settle in?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to be when you grow up? Why?	Do you have a dream job?	What do you need to learn to do that job?
	Is there a place in the world you would like to visit or live in?	China or another country?	What do you think it would be like?
	Why do you want to come to our school?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope to learn here?
Values (choose one)	Your friend breaks a classmate's pencil and says nothing. What do you do?	Is that OK?	Why?
	A new student cannot speak your language and sits alone. What do you do?	Would you play with them?	How could you help them?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, for a child of this age, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the child is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single words and memorised phrases. Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported with pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences about familiar things (family, school, likes). Frequent errors. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with short connected sentences ("because", "and then", "but"). Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Everyday vocabulary.
D Competent	Talks easily and at some length, explains and gives examples, manages most stretch prompts. Occasional errors that rarely affect meaning.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or what you saw.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age
Attitude to learning and resilience	Keen to learn, has a go, keeps trying when work is hard
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest, enjoys talking about ideas
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves, ready for a new school
Independence and self-management	Follows instructions, looks after belongings, can work alone for a short time, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and polite in the interview and the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Happy to try speaking English even with mistakes, interested in learning English

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision, coordination)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, very heavy after-school workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the child's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, a picture word book, seating near the teacher) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Aim for about 120 words a minute in Years 1 and 2, 120 in Year 3, 130 in Year 4, 140 in Year 5, 155 in Year 6, 160 in Year 7, 160 in Year 8, 175 in Year 9 and 185 in Year 10. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.